

too supports many thousands of arcade machine games. This, ladies and gentlemen, is what historical records look like when it comes to the field of computers.

One of the problems you run into with MESS and MAME is the same one you could face with DOSBox. These are command line tools with tonnes of options and configuration parameters. Like with DOSBox, you can use a GUI frontend that simplifies things for you.

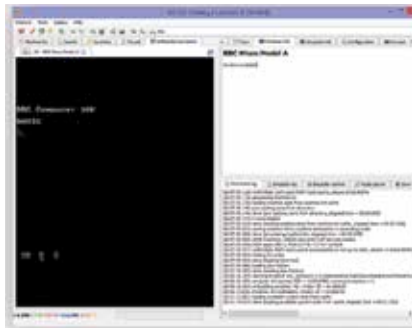
A good one is QMC2, a cross-platform (Windows, Linux, OSX) software the automates a large part of using MESS and MAME for you. It automatically populates the GUI with the thousands of software and games, and architectures and systems it supports. You can then simply click on a game to launch it, or on a computer system to emulate it.

Another problem you are likely to face with MESS and MAME is that while the software does emulate a vast range of hardware across many decades, it does not “emulate” any of their software. Obviously all such systems shipped with their operating systems and software suites, but all that doesn’t come with MAME / MESS. In fact most systems also need a ROM to even boot.

If you’re wondering what a ROM really is, let us explain. ROM stands for Read Only Memory. Even modern computers have ROM chips that are used for the BIOS (Basic Input Output System) that is the first bit of code to be executed when the system boots. This BIOS code stored in a ROM is what then further starts the rest of the system.



QMC2's arcade interface for playing old-school arcade games using MAME.



QMC2's running the emulator for the BBC Micro Model A machine using MESS.